# *An AI Agent Creates a Data Center Report with Me*

*~ Meta's Muse, a personalized autonomous AI agent, became my partner*

*David L. Passmore, https://davidpassmore.net, 18 October 2026*

Every Tuesday, I distribute by email a note summarizing recent developments and concerns about data centers. I do not produce a comprehensive review of these developments and concerns. Instead, I identify four publicly available articles from my reading that pertain to central and western Pennsylvania. I send my weekly email note to members of *The Battle of Homestead Foundation* ("Mission & History," 2026) and to a group of friends—aka, *Pennsylvania Think Tank*—who meet on Zoom every morning, except Sundays and holidays, to discuss the sublime and the ordinary. [1]

In this essay, I describe my employment of *Muse* (2026a), an autonomous personal AI agent (*AI Agent Standards Initiative*, 2026) created by Meta (*About Meta*, 2026) that can independently execute multi-step tasks and pursue long-term goals on my behalf. I, but *not* because producing a weekly note is burdensome. I read daily about data centers. Annotating information from my readings is already part of my workflow. Partnering with *Muse* multiplies my effort while also giving me valuable experience initiating and implementing AI agents.

As a cheap bastard, I like *Muse* because Meta offers extensive compute without charge. *Muse* is also user-friendly and accessible (Sarantakos & Awad, 2026). It aims to simplify tasks and enhance productivity without requiring advanced technical knowledge. *Muse* lowers the barrier to learning about personalized AI agents, which commonly present an IT skill barrier to entry (cf. Shakudo Team, 2026).

Because *Data Center News* focuses on the data center movement and its associated resource impediments, I provide a brief primer about data centers in the next section of this essay. I follow with a description of my *Muse* installation. I, then, explain the setup of my personal AI assistant from *Muse*. To wind it all together, I share a detailed story about my partnership with *Muse* to create the 13 October 2026 issue of *Data Center News* (Passmore, 2026b, 2026a), which migrates my former email distribution into a redesigned document.

[1] Many members of this group are men who have met consistently for >25 years. Not surprisingly, they are old coots who have seen a lot and experienced much.

I am not proselytizing for adoption of autonomous personalized AI agents. I merely kick the tires and report what I observe. I do not review in this essay Meta's privacy policy for *Muse* (described at Meta Help Center, 2026), but many questions are evident about the privacy and security of this relatively new app (see, e.g., Gerwirtz, 2026; *Meta Muse AI Agent Raises Privacy Fears for Non-Users*, 2026; Studio Global AI, 2026). Personal installation of an AI agent involves assessing risk—gauging against a "pucker factor," if you will—when adopting new networked technology (Sudirman et al., 2026). *Consumptor cave!*

## FIRST, WHAT IS A DATA CENTER?

A data center is a physical room, building, or facility that houses servers, storage, networking gear, and the power systems to continuously build, run, and deliver networked applications and services (Susnjara & Smalley, 2024). It also stores and manages the data associated with those applications and services. To cool these computing assets, the typical large data center uses 1 to 5 million gallons of water per day, or roughly 300 million to 1.8 billion gallons per year. Smaller enterprise facilities might use 10,000 to 100,000 gallons daily (Drew, 2026).

As of Fall 2026, approximately 3,900 to 4,280 active data centers operate in the U.S., representing over 60 GW of operating capacity (*US Data Center Map — Project List & Tracker*, 2026). Sinclair (2026) estimates that roughly 580 to 610 large-scale hyperscale facilities support massive data processing and storage. Hundreds of individual facilities are also under construction nationwide. For example, Texas alone is rumored to have 140 data centers under construction. In addition, 1,500 to 2,595 projects are in the pipeline nationally, representing over 240 to 385 GW of announced future capacity.[2]

Concerns about data centers dominating the news cycle are hard to miss. The rapid expansion of energy-intensive data centers places immense strains on regional electrical grids, driving up utility costs for residents and complicating efforts to transition to clean energy (Walker & Goldsmith, 2026). Facilities also consume millions of gallons of water daily for cooling systems, threatening local water tables and intensifying supply risks in drought-prone regions (Patrick, 2026). Furthermore, communities raise concerns over air and noise pollution from cooling equipment and backup generators (*Data Center Air Pollution*, 2026), the conversion of prime agricultural land (Bharath, 2026), and relatively

[2] Estimates of the number of data centers vary remarkably (Mahan, 2026).

low permanent job creation due to heavy, but short-lived, site development and construction of centers (Sharma, 2026; “The Data Center Job Gap,” 2026).

According to Juniewicz (2026), investment in AI-related data center construction, compute hardware, and networking equipment accounted for ~0.8% of U.S. gross domestic product (GDP) in Q1 2026, driving computing infrastructure as a whole to ~1.5% of GDP, up from a 2015–2022 average of ~0.7%. AI infrastructure is now the leading driver of growth in private investment in the U.S., exceeding housing investment (Ma, 2026). AI-related capital spending[3] contributed ~1.09 percentage points[4] to U.S. real (inflation-adjusted) GDP growth in Q1 2026, roughly matching the contribution from all household consumption combined and exceeding a similar investment boom in the dot-com era from the mid-1900s to 2000 (Beta, 2026; Rubinton & Patro, 2026).

## HOW *MUSE* & I BECAME BUDDIES

### *Installation*

I downloaded *Muse* (AI at Meta, 2026) for my Macintosh desktop computer and for my iPhone. *Muse* installed with a simple double-click on my Macintosh M4 Mini (24 GB RAM) running MacOS Golden Gate 27.01. A similar simple install occurred on my Apple iPhone 16 Pro running iOS version 27.0.1. *Muse* can also run through *WhatsApp*.

### *General Usage*

*Muse* is free to use, with a usage limit that is quite generous compared to most other AI models. My work is not throttled by a usage cap yet, but my current usage is not extraordinary. -*Muse* sessions are transparent and carry over between my desktop and my phone in a chat window, a common user interface that is familiar, by now, to most general users. Meta (2026b) explains that:

> Because it’s agentic AI, when you give *Muse* a task, it figures out which built-in skills it needs and gets to work. It can browse the web, pull information from connected apps, and take action across multiple steps.

[3] Investments in information processing equipment, software, R&D, and data centers.

[4] A percentage point change is not the same as a percent change. A percent change measures the relative change between an old value and a new value, expressed as a share of the starting value. A percentage point change measures the arithmetic difference between two percentages (consult Social Studies Help, 2026).

You stay in control by setting permissions, reviewing and approving what it does along the way.

### *My Assistant: Kaz*

My assistant's name, my *Muse* agent, is *Kaz* (short for Kazimir), based on the image of the last of the many greyhounds I lived with. A good boy; now a good personal AI agent. I address my assistant in text or voice as Kaz. His image, created from a single photo I uploaded, appears as an avatar.



Kaz appears as a default at the top of my *Muse* chatbot window



When Kaz is completing tasks for me, he changes to this avatar, animated to show him typing

### *Kaz's Job Description*

Rather than walk through the (rather simple, it turns out) technicalities of setting up Kaz as my personal assistant, I describe Kaz's roles from a functional perspective.

So, Kaz is my personal AI assistant, made by Meta. He has his own virtual computer in the cloud that works for me between our conversations—researching topics, writing and editing documents, checking facts, comparing products or services, planning travel, finding places with accessible parking and step-free access, setting reminders, and organizing information. Kaz remembers my preferences so I do not need to repeat myself. He can look things up on the web, use his own browser, and work with accounts I connect, like email or calendar.

Kaz works only for me and answers only to me. He does not talk to anyone else on my behalf unless I specifically ask, and he never shares my private information—my messages, files, accounts, or anything I have told him—with family, friends, or anyone else without my explicit permission. Anything Kaz does that matters, like sending a message, making a purchase, or deleting data, requires my approval first, and I see exactly what I am approving. I grant permissions one at a time.

For example, I might let him read my email, draft replies, change my calendar, order Thai food for delivery, or use my computer. I can review or remove these permissions. What I tell Kaz stays with Kaz, just like when he was my flesh-and-blood good boy.

***Examples of Kaz's Work***

Say I ask Kaz to buy a desk chair I specified by writing my requirements and uploading photos of chairs I like. First, he shops around and brings me options with full prices. No payment involved yet. When I pick one, Kaz prepares a complete checkout review: the merchant, the exact item and quantity, shipping cost and delivery estimate, taxes, fees, and the total, plus the payment method, which is shown only as something like "Visa ….1234." My card number itself lives in my digital wallet. Kaz never sees or stores the full number. I am never asked to type card details into a chat.

Then, I approve the purchase on a secure approval screen. That approval covers exactly the reviewed order, the stated total, and nothing more. Kaz completes the purchase and reports back what the merchant confirmed. Each purchase needs its own approval; Kaz cannot reuse an old approval, set up a subscription, or change the order on his own. If I ever change my mind at any step, nothing is charged. And that is the whole flow: review, approve, report, with the card itself staying out of sight.

Another example, now.

Kaz can book a table for dinner. I ask Kaz to book me a table at "Rutters Diner" for 7 pm Saturday. Kaz does not just start calling around. First, he notices that there is no place in Pittsburgh by that name and figures out I probably mean Ritter's Diner on Baum Blvd. He asks me to confirm rather than booking on a guess. Then, he checks and reports the facts: Ritter's is open Saturdays 7 am to 8 pm, it is cash-only, and it does not take reservations. So, Kaz cannot make a 7 pm Saturday reservation. Kaz tells me that instead of inventing one.

Kaz also checks my accessibility needs. Ritter's website shows parking and wheelchair access. Kaz offers honest alternatives: go as a walk-in earlier in the evening or let Kaz find a nearby restaurant that does take Saturday-evening reservations. Nothing gets booked until I choose an option and confirm. Kaz checks facts, flags uncertainty, respects my constraints, and never invents a result. If something cannot be done, he says so. Maybe I should bring a nice treat home for him, don't you believe?

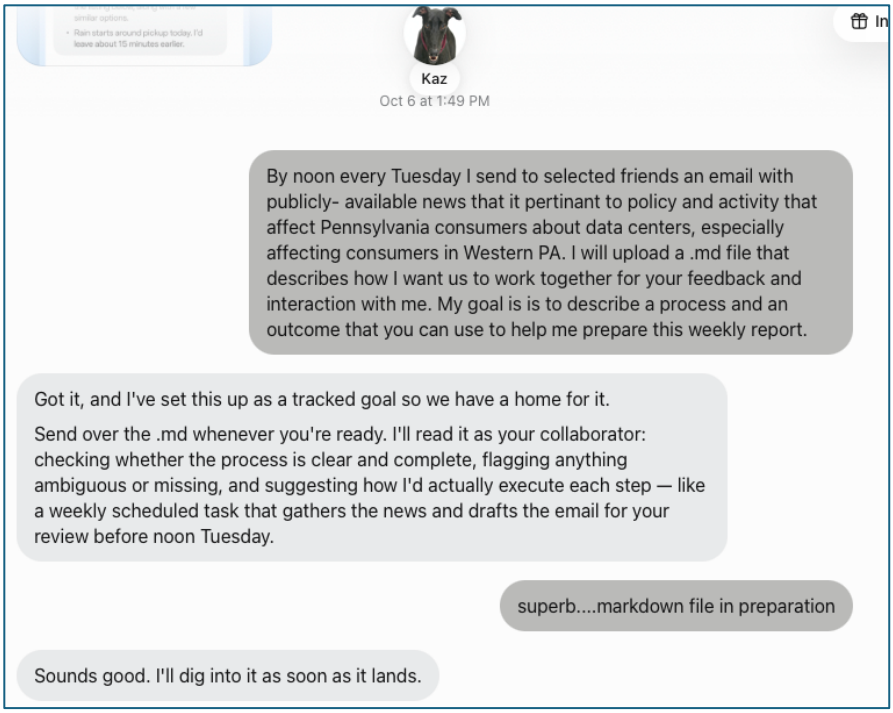
Next: How Kaz partners with me to create the weekly *Data Center News*.

## DAVID & KAZ'S PARTNERSHIP FOR *DATA CENTER NEWS*

In this section of the essay, I cut and paste conversations I had with Kaz to produce the 13 October 2026 *Data Center News*. I present the conversations sequentially, from the first design discussion until approval of the 13 October issue. My part of the conversation usually is on the right of the page, embedded in a screened box. Kaz's work is left-justified in a box, with a lighter screen over his text than mine. You should find the conversations easy to follow.

For the most part, I did not enter conversation text by typing on a keyboard. I dictate most of my conversations using *Wispr Flow* (*Wispr Flow | Voice to Text Dictation & AI Notetaker*, 2026), a voice-to-text AI that turns speech into writing. Over the previous 108 days, I dictated >60,000 words through *Wispr Flow* (it says, equal to 13 short film scripts), 2/3 of which were for text messages—and 2/3 of those words in texts were dictated on my iPhone. *Wispr Flow* corrected my spelling and grammar about 2,000 times. It adapted to my style by adding 522 proper names, technical words, and place names that I frequently speak to its dictionary. My dictation speed is 3 times my typing speed.

*I start with our first conversation about the project:*




*[continues]*

While your workflow .md is in progress, here's a head start on next Tuesday's email — this week's PA data center consumer news, gathered today:

- **PUC advances curtailment order.** At its Oct 1 public meeting, the PA PUC approved a tentative order on emergency load control: data centers are *not* critical load and get curtailed before other customers. Out for public comment now; final order targeted Jan 28, 2027. RTO Insider
- **AWS files for 36 data centers at Homer City (Western PA).** Amazon filed a preliminary master plan with Indiana County for ~1,100 acres, powered by a 4.4–4.5 GW gas plant. The county planning commission tabled it Sept 9, triggering a ~90-day review. Data Center Frontier / Marcellus Drilling News
- **PJM capacity costs still driving bills.** July's auction cleared at the $325/MW-day cap with a 6,831 MW shortfall; data centers account for ~46% of capacity charges, and PA ratepayers are paying an extra $220–320/year. WESA
- **Context.** Shapiro's Aug 18 executive order directs the PUC to prioritize data center curtailment and cost allocation; the PUC's April 30 model tariff and PPL's $11M/yr large-load universal-service charge are the guardrails. Daily Energy Insider

Two items I didn't verify: the fall technical conference date and the September PJM follow-up auction outcomes — both worth a live check before the draft goes out.

Dig into Duquesne Light / West Penn Power + re-verify the open items

Set up the weekly Monday gather-and-draft

I've got it from here

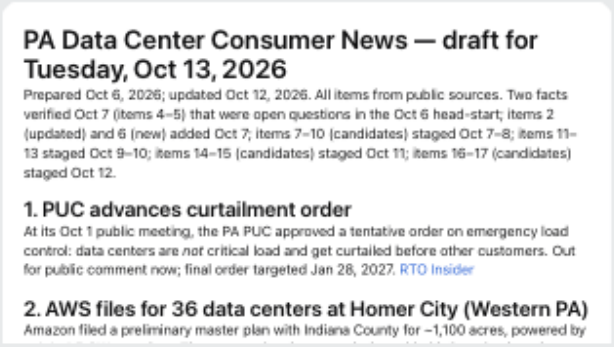
*[continues]*

Oct 7 at 3:22 PM

Two updates on Tuesday's email.

The letter above closes the two loose ends from yesterday's digest — the technical conference is Nov 17, and the PJM backstop auction is frozen until Feb 2027 — plus one deadline worth flagging high: panelist applications close Oct 14, a day after your email goes out.

I also added two new items to the working draft (



**PA Data Center Consumer News — draft for Tuesday, Oct 13, 2026**

Prepared Oct 6, 2026; updated Oct 12, 2026. All items from public sources. Two facts verified Oct 7 (items 4–5) that were open questions in the Oct 6 head-start; items 2 (updated) and 6 (new) added Oct 7; items 7–10 (candidates) staged Oct 7–8; items 11–13 staged Oct 9–10; items 14–15 (candidates) staged Oct 11; items 16–17 (candidates) staged Oct 12.

**1. PUC advances curtailment order**

At its Oct 1 public meeting, the PA PUC approved a tentative order on emergency load control: data centers are *not* critical load and get curtailed before other customers. Out for public comment now; final order targeted Jan 28, 2027. RTO Insider

**2. AWS files for 36 data centers at Homer City (Western PA)**

Amazon filed a preliminary master plan with Indiana County for ~1,100 acres, powered by

MD **draft-2026-10-13.md**
MD

):

- PA House Energy Committee advanced three data-center cost bills last week — HB 2828 (builder-pays infrastructure, peak-day curtailment), HB 2755 (kill the FERC RTO profit bonus), HB 2775 (electric-service application before zoning). Floor votes possible in the eight remaining session days.
- Oct 14 DEP public meeting + hearing on the Homer City water-permit amendment, 5:00–7:30pm at Homer Center High School. Same day as the PUC panelist deadline, so Oct 14 is double-booked for Homer City watchers.

Still planning the Monday Oct 12 re-check on the county review status and FERC before the draft ships.

*[continues]*

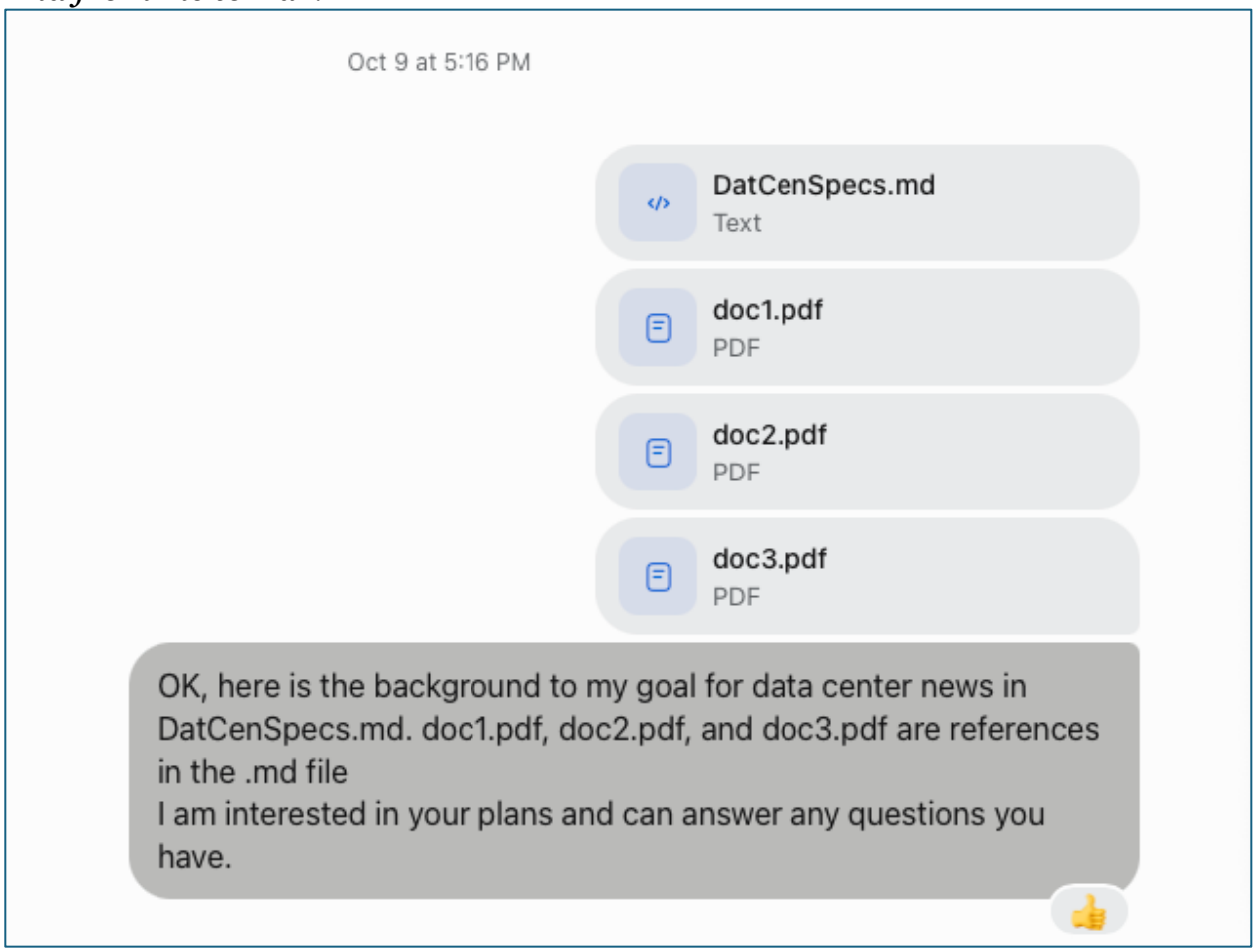
Oct 8 at 3:23 PM

More for Tuesday's draft — all four are staged as candidates in the working draft, the cut is yours:

- **Fuel-cell data center in Luzerne County.** Fit Energy announced Oct 6 a data center + natural-gas fuel-cell plant in Newport Township on former mined land; zoning approved Aug 2026, FuelCell Energy supplying on-site generation. Eastern PA, but a clean on-site-power model. POWER Magazine
- **PUC reliability study (Sept 14).** Synapse analysis: data-center demand nearly doubling 2025–2040; by 2030 the grid misses PJM's reliability standard ~6x over, worst case ~13 blackout days a year. Modeled risk, not a forecast. Allegheny Front
- **Capitol moratorium rally (Oct 6).** ~100 people rallied for a three-year data-center moratorium; petitions delivered to legislators and Shapiro. The bill has sat in the Senate Local Government Committee since June. GoErie
- **Luzerne County votes today (2 p.m., Wilkes-Barre)** on loosened data-center zoning — setbacks 2,000→1,250 ft, higher noise limits — while Bethlehem voted 7-0 to tighten. I'll confirm the outcome in Monday's re-check. Sunday Dispatch

The House bills from yesterday are already in the draft — not repeated here.

*And from me to Kaz:*




*These are the specifications in DatCenSpecs.md that I sent to Kaz. This was the job I wanted Kaz to complete:*

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*DatCenSpecs*

Project:

News about policy and activity re data centers in Pennsylvania

**Goal:**
Produce a document containing news about policy and activity for data centers that interests Pennsylvania consumers, especially consumers located in Western Pennsylvania.

Deadlines:

I must receive a draft of the document for review by or before 9:00 am every Tuesday. Then, I must receive revisions by noon every Tuesday to the 9:00 am draft document based on my review.

Period:

One week prior to the draft document prepared for my review.

Features:

- News identified is publicly-accessible by a hyperlink. Nothing behind a paywall.
- All sources are verified and verifiable. Fake information is a failure.
- Favored news is from sources that appear credible in print or non-print media (including New York Times, Wall Street Journal, The Economist, YouTube), from University researchers or research labs, from refereed publications, from preprint sources (such as ArXiv or EconStor) from scholarly conference proceedings, from government agencies, or the like.
- Less favored news is from press releases or announcements, unless these are the first or sole sources, or from secondary sources when no primary sources are available.
- Unfavored news is from social media such as Facebook, Twitter, TikTok, Instagram, Reddit, or BlueSky.

**Elements:**

- The document is no larger than one 8.5" by 11" page, with margins suitable to allow printing.
- Employs a simple professional look, employing modern typography and open layout. No color on the page background.
- Contains a -
    - a header with the title: "Data Center News"; subtitle: "The Battle of Homestead Foundation; and the calendar date of the Tuesday for which the document is prepared
    - a body that contains four summaries of news about policy and activity re data centers in Pennsylvania with hyperlinks to the source of news.
    - a footer with the attribution, "Prepared by David L. Passmore, passmore.david@gmail.com, https://DavidPassmore.net"
    - filler, when appropriate, consisting of call-outs or the like.
- More about summaries -
    - No need for comprehensiveness, but should draw selectively attention to key information

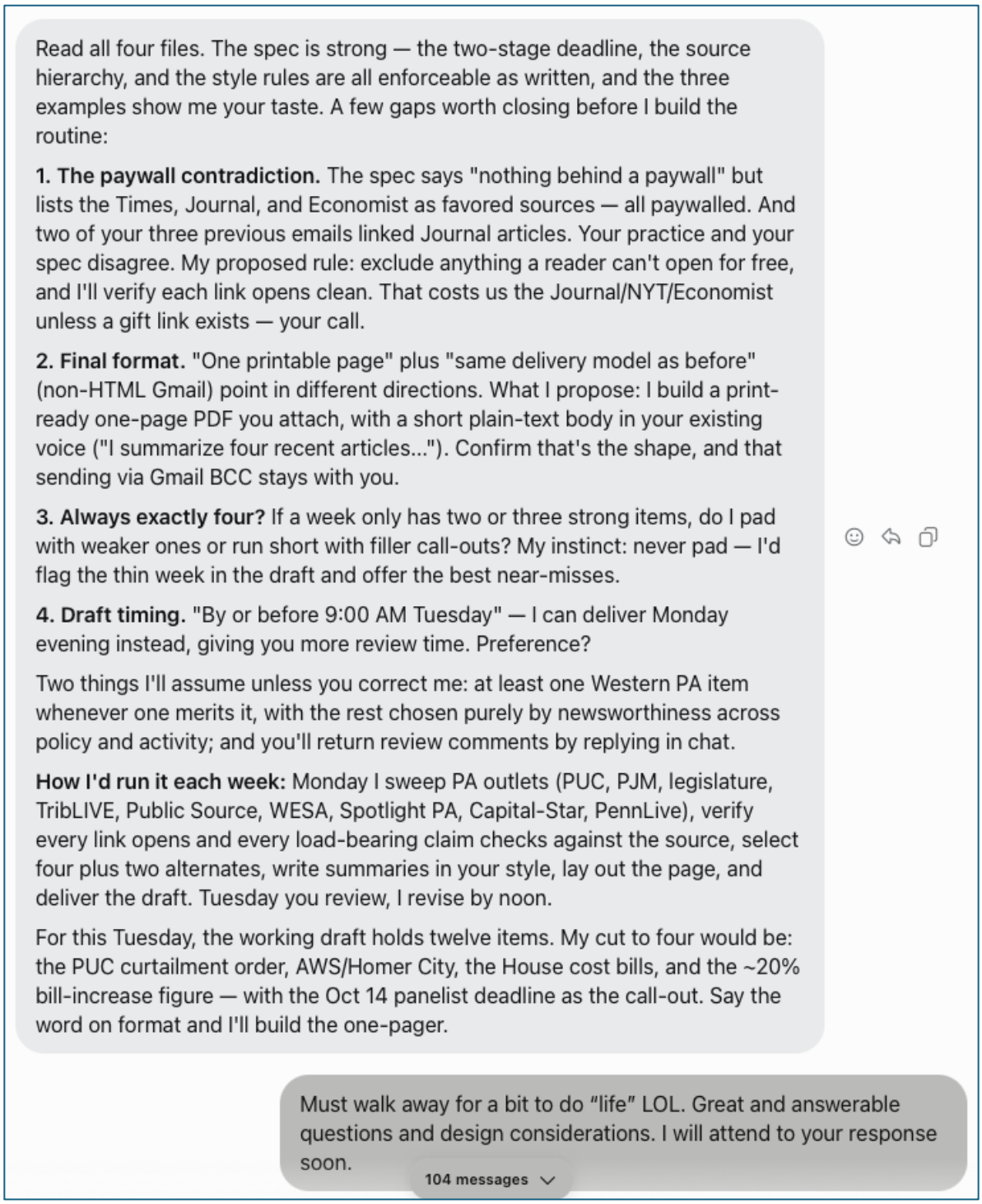
- Avoid dead statements such as “In this article” that do not add to the signal.
- Spell out acronyms on first use.
- Employ simple sentences, avoiding complex sentence structure.
- Define technical terms concisely, when a technical term is necessary.
- Avoid passive voice.
- Assume a high school vocabulary for readers. Explain simply; do not confuse.

**History:**
A previous version of this news was delivered by email. I anticipate that I will use the same model of delivery for the instance you are designing. The previous versions were non-HTML messages in Gmail notes, with recipients hidden as BCCs. I am uploading as three previous news deliveries so you can view my approach preparing the 4 articles I chose to summarize. These three are in doc1.pdf, doc2.pdf, doc3.pdf

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*End of specs.*

*Kaz has feedback for me about this job. He wants to know how he can make his owner happy. I like it! Isn't he my good boy?*



Read all four files. The spec is strong — the two-stage deadline, the source hierarchy, and the style rules are all enforceable as written, and the three examples show me your taste. A few gaps worth closing before I build the routine:

**1. The paywall contradiction.** The spec says "nothing behind a paywall" but lists the Times, Journal, and Economist as favored sources — all paywalled. And two of your three previous emails linked Journal articles. Your practice and your spec disagree. My proposed rule: exclude anything a reader can't open for free, and I'll verify each link opens clean. That costs us the Journal/NYT/Economist unless a gift link exists — your call.

**2. Final format.** "One printable page" plus "same delivery model as before" (non-HTML Gmail) point in different directions. What I propose: I build a print-ready one-page PDF you attach, with a short plain-text body in your existing voice ("I summarize four recent articles..."). Confirm that's the shape, and that sending via Gmail BCC stays with you.

**3. Always exactly four?** If a week only has two or three strong items, do I pad with weaker ones or run short with filler call-outs? My instinct: never pad — I'd flag the thin week in the draft and offer the best near-misses.

**4. Draft timing.** "By or before 9:00 AM Tuesday" — I can deliver Monday evening instead, giving you more review time. Preference?

Two things I'll assume unless you correct me: at least one Western PA item whenever one merits it, with the rest chosen purely by newsworthiness across policy and activity; and you'll return review comments by replying in chat.

**How I'd run it each week:** Monday I sweep PA outlets (PUC, PJM, legislature, TribLIVE, Public Source, WESA, Spotlight PA, Capital-Star, PennLive), verify every link opens and every load-bearing claim checks against the source, select four plus two alternates, write summaries in your style, lay out the page, and deliver the draft. Tuesday you review, I revise by noon.

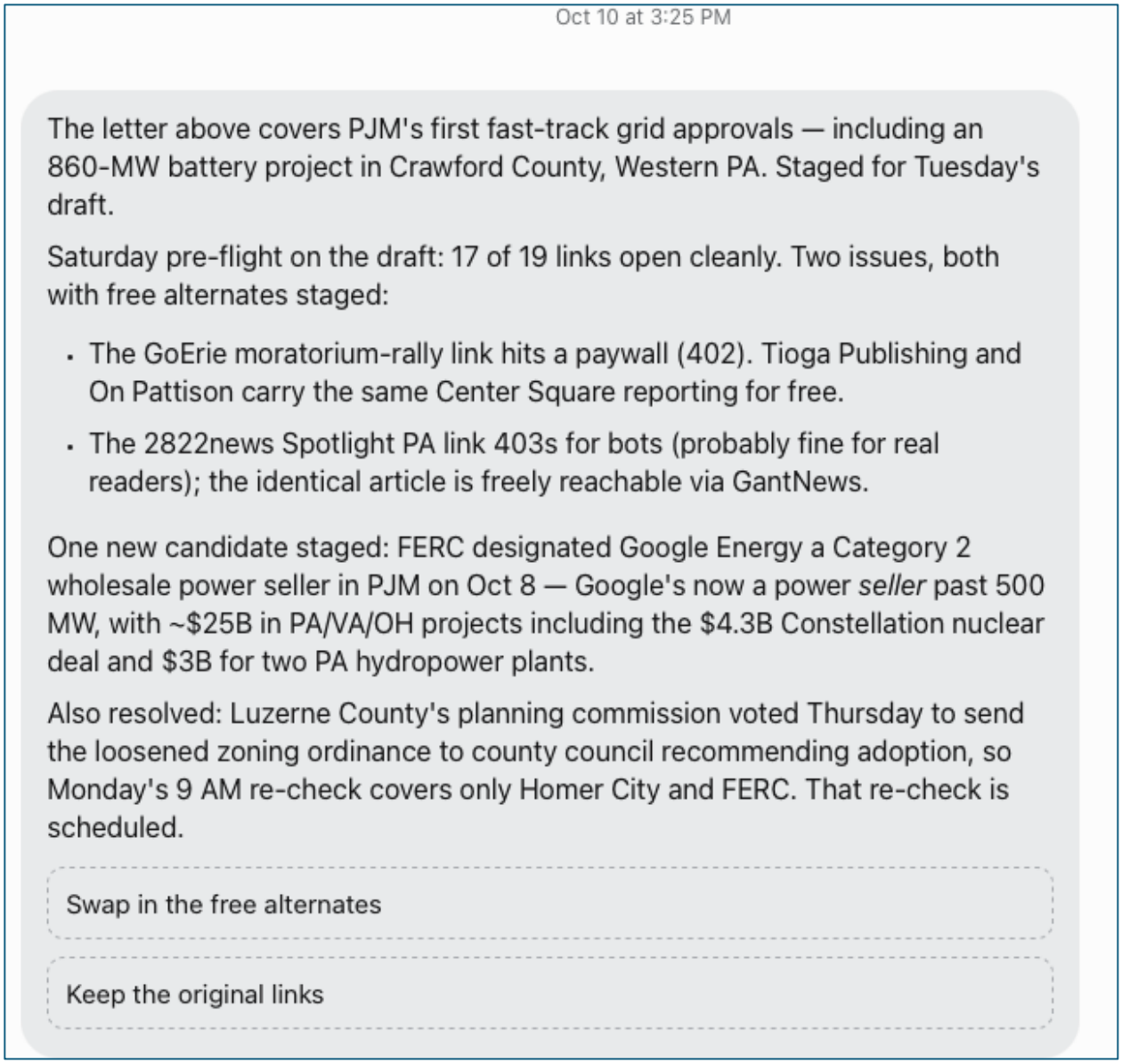
For this Tuesday, the working draft holds twelve items. My cut to four would be: the PUC curtailment order, AWS/Homer City, the House cost bills, and the ~20% bill-increase figure — with the Oct 14 panelist deadline as the call-out. Say the word on format and I'll build the one-pager.

Must walk away for a bit to do "life" LOL. Great and answerable questions and design considerations. I will attend to your response soon.

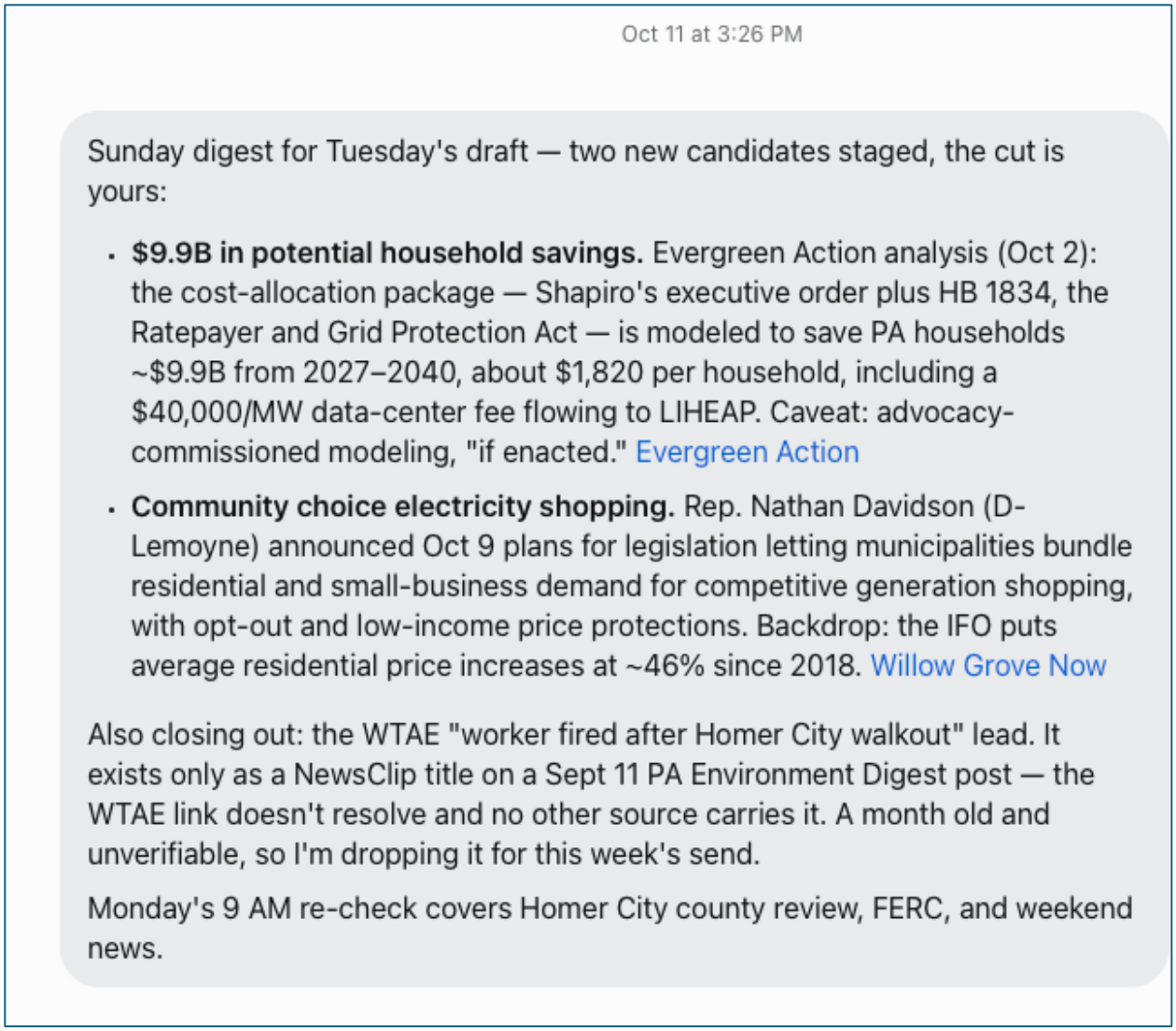
104 messages

Take your time — I'll be here when you're back.

*I walk away for a while. Kaz keeps working in the background:*



*More work by Kaz:*



Oct 11 at 3:26 PM

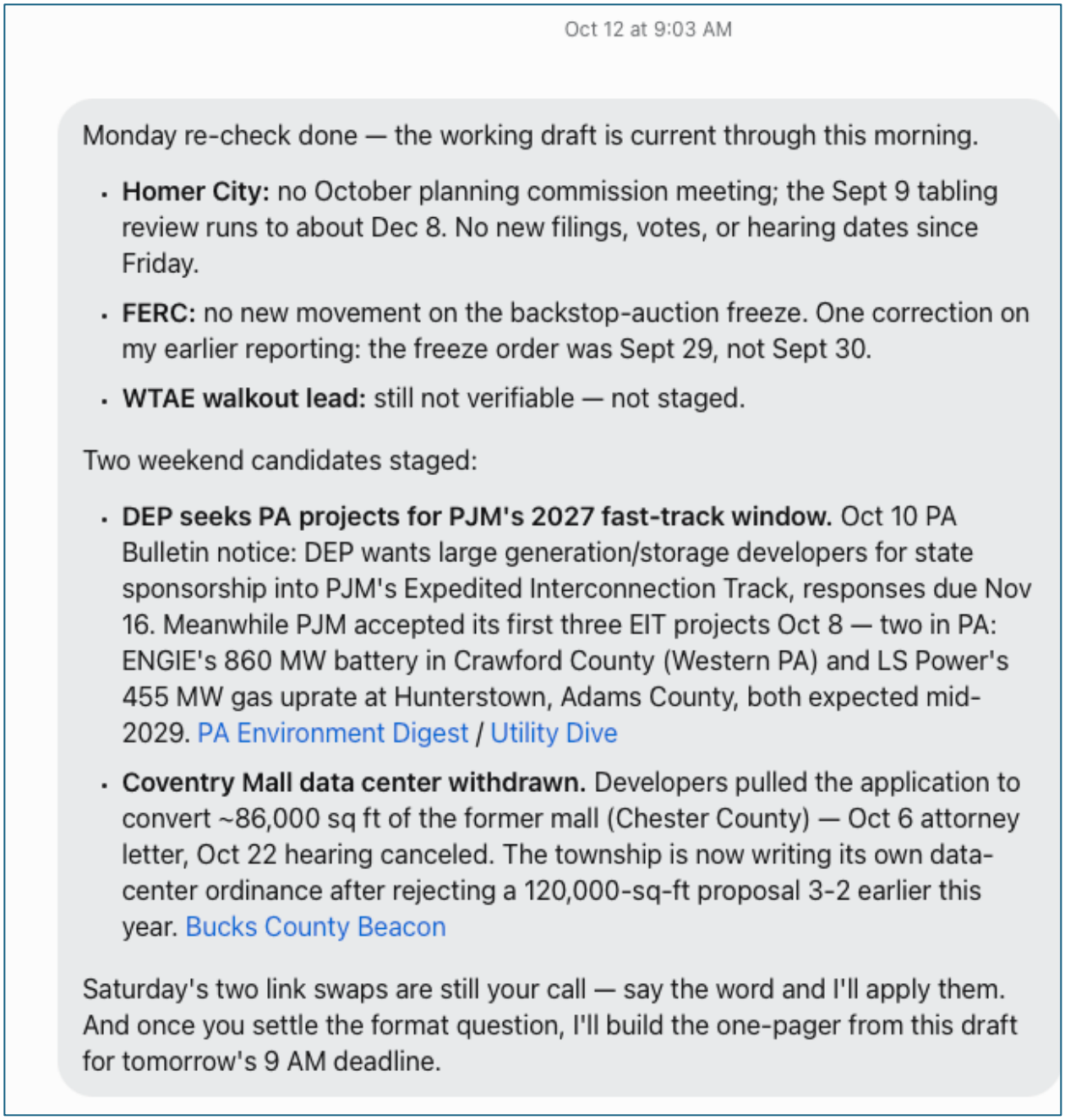
Sunday digest for Tuesday's draft — two new candidates staged, the cut is yours:

- **$9.9B in potential household savings.** Evergreen Action analysis (Oct 2): the cost-allocation package — Shapiro's executive order plus HB 1834, the Ratepayer and Grid Protection Act — is modeled to save PA households ~$9.9B from 2027–2040, about $1,820 per household, including a $40,000/MW data-center fee flowing to LIHEAP. Caveat: advocacy-commissioned modeling, "if enacted." Evergreen Action
- **Community choice electricity shopping.** Rep. Nathan Davidson (D-Lemoyne) announced Oct 9 plans for legislation letting municipalities bundle residential and small-business demand for competitive generation shopping, with opt-out and low-income price protections. Backdrop: the IFO puts average residential price increases at ~46% since 2018. Willow Grove Now

Also closing out: the WTAE "worker fired after Homer City walkout" lead. It exists only as a NewsClip title on a Sept 11 PA Environment Digest post — the WTAE link doesn't resolve and no other source carries it. A month old and unverifiable, so I'm dropping it for this week's send.

Monday's 9 AM re-check covers Homer City county review, FERC, and weekend news.

*Even more hard work by Kaz:*



Oct 12 at 9:03 AM

Monday re-check done — the working draft is current through this morning.

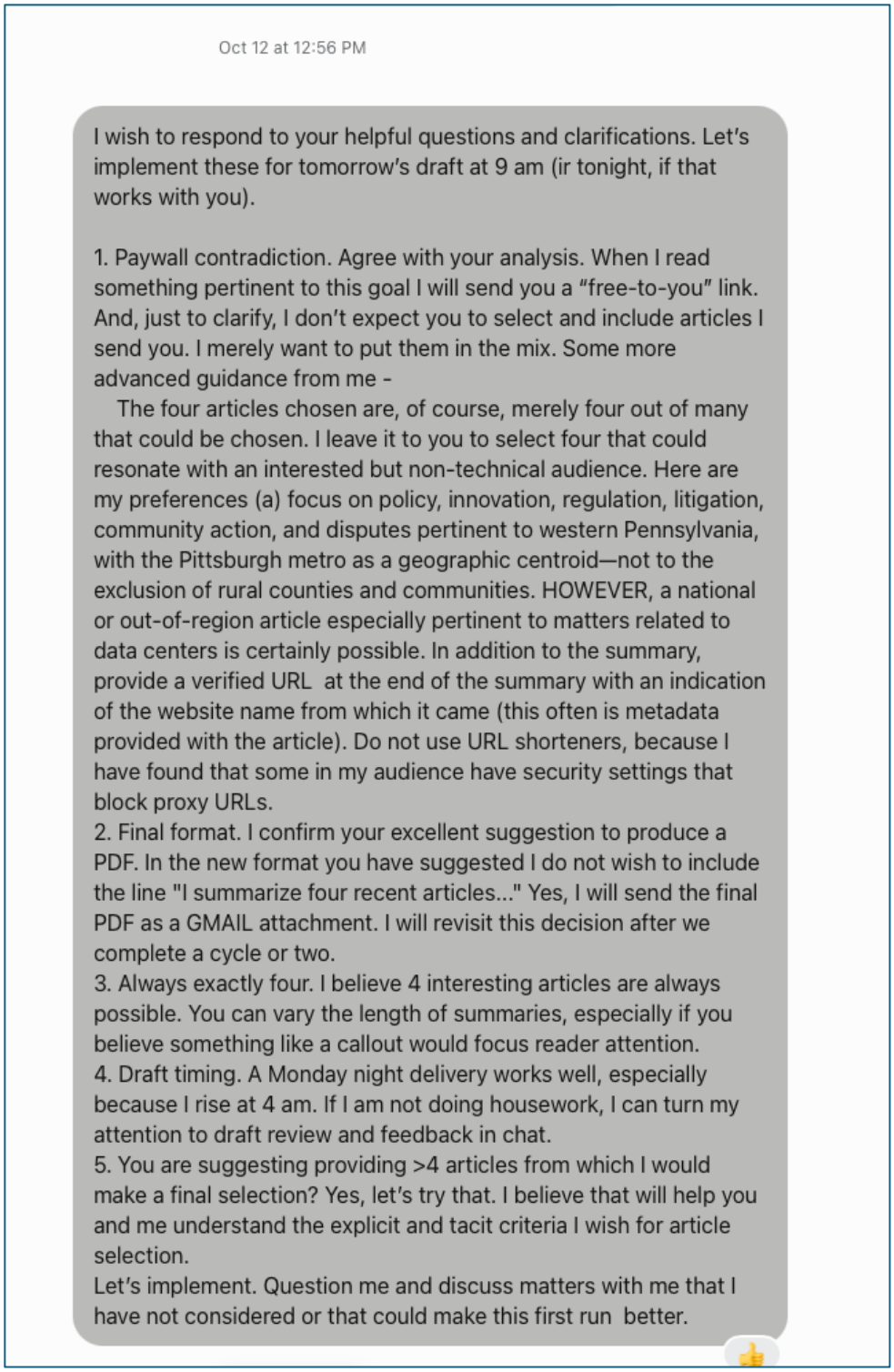
- **Homer City:** no October planning commission meeting; the Sept 9 tabling review runs to about Dec 8. No new filings, votes, or hearing dates since Friday.
- **FERC:** no new movement on the backstop-auction freeze. One correction on my earlier reporting: the freeze order was Sept 29, not Sept 30.
- **WTAE walkout lead:** still not verifiable — not staged.

Two weekend candidates staged:

- **DEP seeks PA projects for PJM's 2027 fast-track window.** Oct 10 PA Bulletin notice: DEP wants large generation/storage developers for state sponsorship into PJM's Expedited Interconnection Track, responses due Nov 16. Meanwhile PJM accepted its first three EIT projects Oct 8 — two in PA: ENGIE's 860 MW battery in Crawford County (Western PA) and LS Power's 455 MW gas uprate at Hunterstown, Adams County, both expected mid-2029. PA Environment Digest / Utility Dive
- **Coventry Mall data center withdrawn.** Developers pulled the application to convert ~86,000 sq ft of the former mall (Chester County) — Oct 6 attorney letter, Oct 22 hearing canceled. The township is now writing its own data-center ordinance after rejecting a 120,000-sq-ft proposal 3-2 earlier this year. Bucks County Beacon

Saturday's two link swaps are still your call — say the word and I'll apply them. And once you settle the format question, I'll build the one-pager from this draft for tomorrow's 9 AM deadline.

*I give feedback to Kaz:*



*Kaz is starting to tie it all together:*

Locked in — all five decisions are recorded against the goal.

Two things I've applied immediately from your paywall call, both verified opening clean just now:

- GoErie moratorium-rally link → Tioga Publishing's free Center Square version.
- The 2822news Spotlight PA link → the identical article via GantNews.
- Also stripped the tracking parameters off the Coventry Mall link — not a shortener, but the same class of thing your audience's security settings may flag.

A few things worth nailing down before tonight:

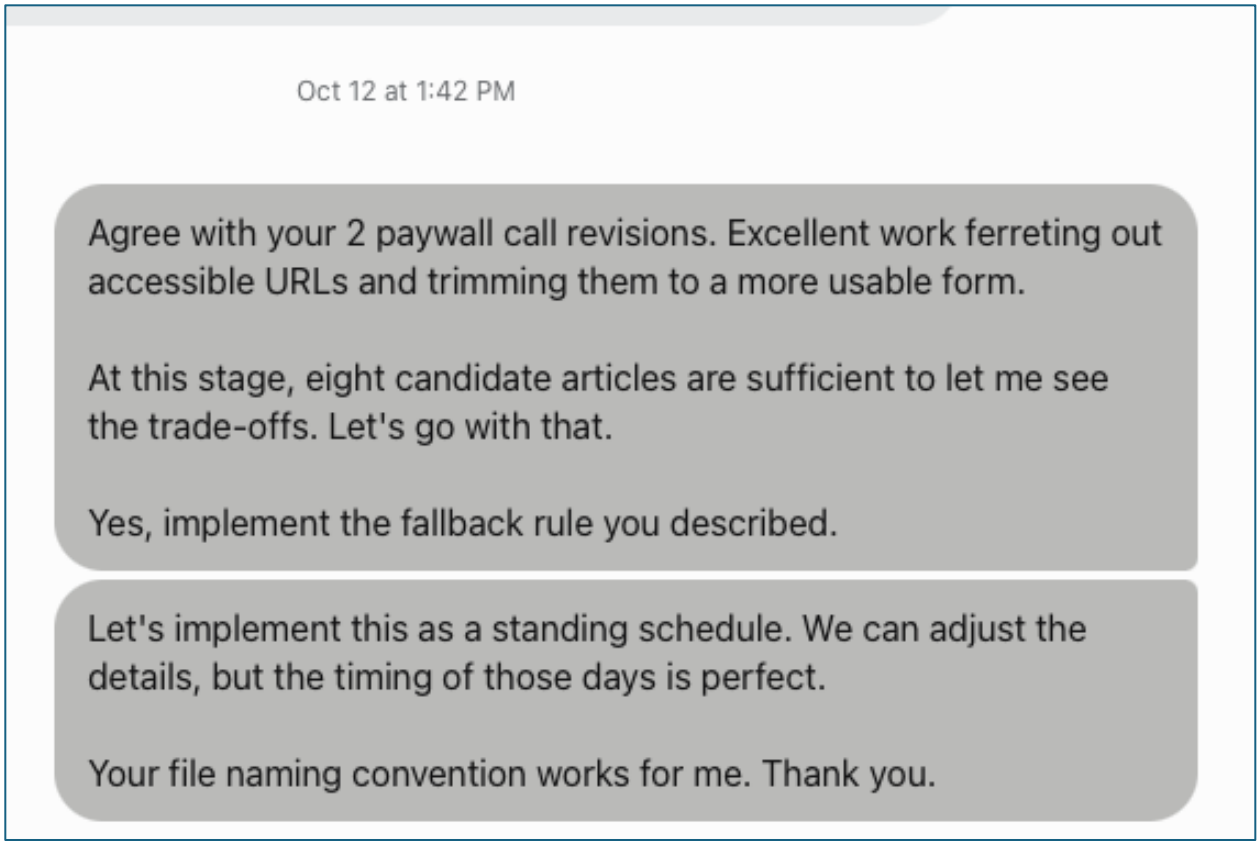
**1. Candidate slate size.** The working draft holds 17 items. For tonight, how many candidates do you want to choose from? I'd propose 8 — enough range to see the trade-offs, not so many it's homework. I can trim or expand.

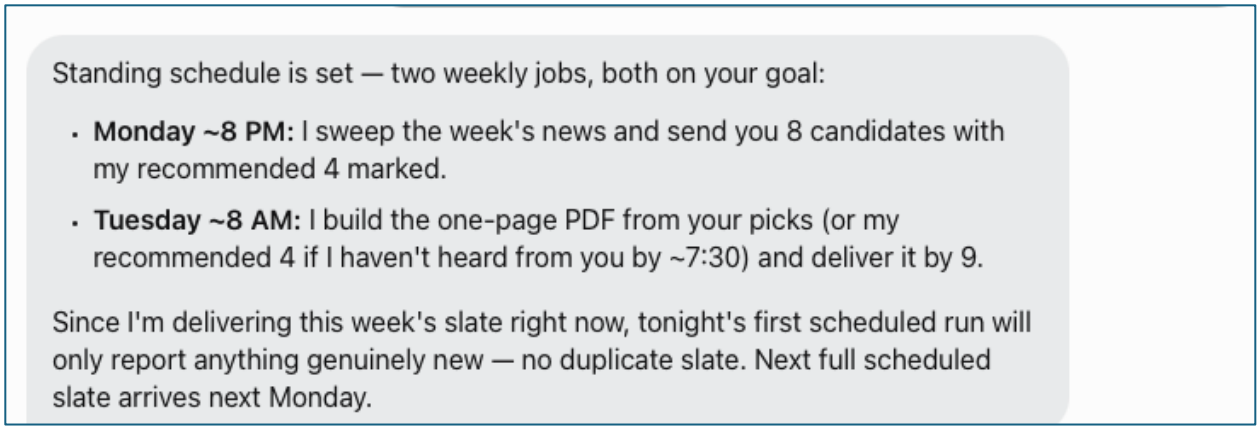
**2. Fallback rule.** You'll likely have picks in early given the 4 AM start. But if I don't hear from you by ~7:30 AM Tuesday, should I build the PDF with my recommended four so the 9 AM deadline holds? I'd rather have a rule than guess.

**3. Standing schedule.** Want to make this a standing Monday-night routine — candidates from me each Monday evening, PDF by 9 AM Tuesday after your picks — or keep it week-by-week while we calibrate?

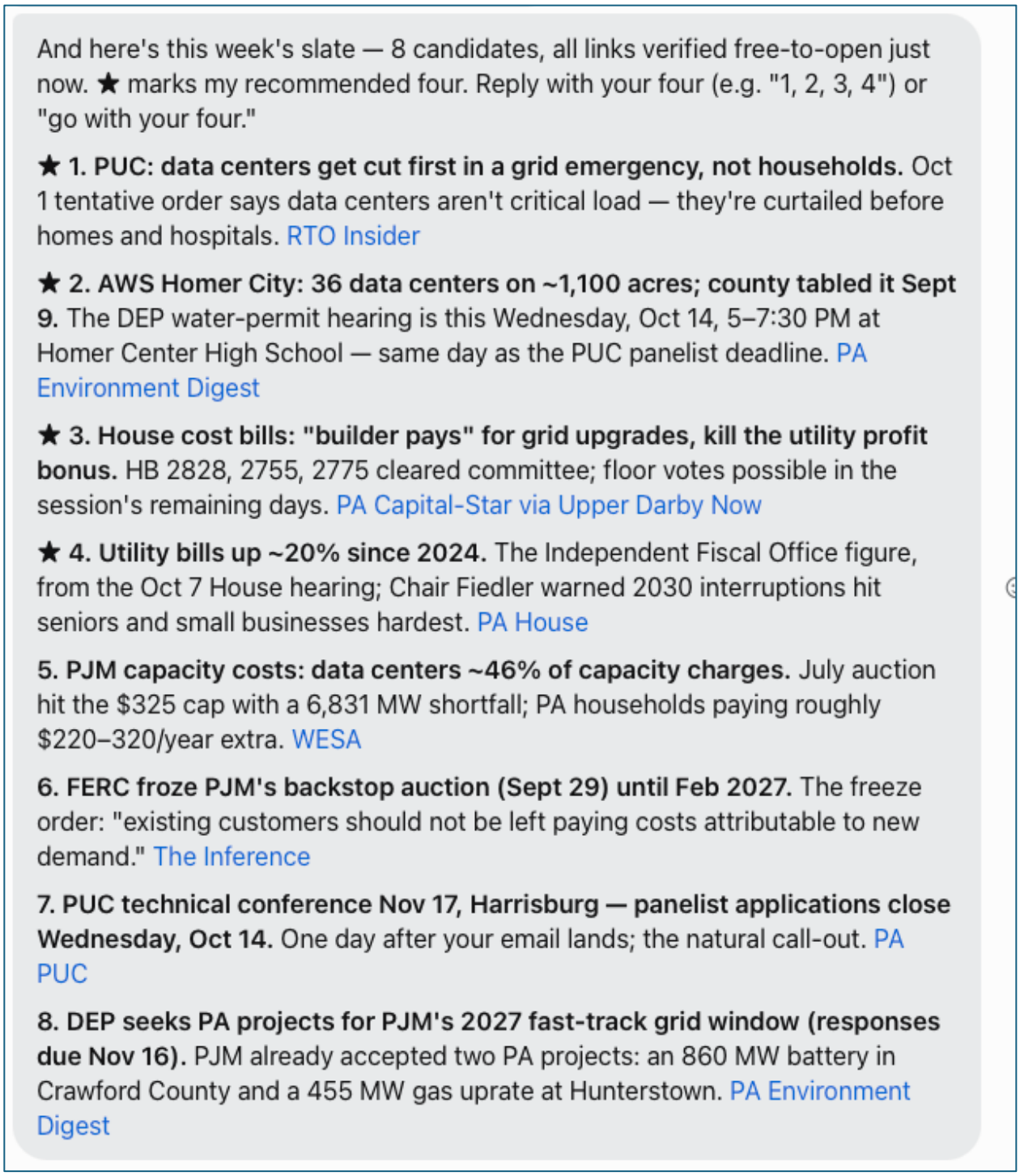
Tonight's plan once you answer: I'll send the slate — each candidate with a one-line hook, my recommended four marked, links verified free-to-open — you pick four, and I'll build the one-page PDF for 9 AM. I'll name the file DataCenterNews-2026-10-13.pdf unless you'd rather a different convention.

*I start to finalize with Kaz:*



*Kaz gives me a slate of eight to choose from. I did not add anything because I want to see how he can finish his work inside my specs:*



And here's this week's slate — 8 candidates, all links verified free-to-open just now. ★ marks my recommended four. Reply with your four (e.g. "1, 2, 3, 4") or "go with your four."

★ **1. PUC: data centers get cut first in a grid emergency, not households.** Oct 1 tentative order says data centers aren't critical load — they're curtailed before homes and hospitals. RTO Insider

★ **2. AWS Homer City: 36 data centers on ~1,100 acres; county tabled it Sept 9.** The DEP water-permit hearing is this Wednesday, Oct 14, 5–7:30 PM at Homer Center High School — same day as the PUC panelist deadline. PA Environment Digest

★ **3. House cost bills: "builder pays" for grid upgrades, kill the utility profit bonus.** HB 2828, 2755, 2775 cleared committee; floor votes possible in the session's remaining days. PA Capital-Star via Upper Darby Now

★ **4. Utility bills up ~20% since 2024.** The Independent Fiscal Office figure, from the Oct 7 House hearing; Chair Fiedler warned 2030 interruptions hit seniors and small businesses hardest. PA House

**5. PJM capacity costs: data centers ~46% of capacity charges.** July auction hit the $325 cap with a 6,831 MW shortfall; PA households paying roughly $220–320/year extra. WESA

**6. FERC froze PJM's backstop auction (Sept 29) until Feb 2027.** The freeze order: "existing customers should not be left paying costs attributable to new demand." The Inference

**7. PUC technical conference Nov 17, Harrisburg — panelist applications close Wednesday, Oct 14.** One day after your email lands; the natural call-out. PA PUC

**8. DEP seeks PA projects for PJM's 2027 fast-track grid window (responses due Nov 16).** PJM already accepted two PA projects: an 860 MW battery in Crawford County and a 455 MW gas uprate at Hunterstown. PA Environment Digest

*OK, we look like we are winding it down:*

The eight candidate slate seems on target. What is your judgement. considering the one-page design, about the number of article summarioes that are possible, while maintaining a clear reader-friendly layout.

Four is the right number, and the math backs your instinct.

On an 8.5×11 page with printable margins, after the header and footer you have roughly 8 inches of body. With four summaries, each gets about 2 inches — around 90 to 110 words at a comfortable 11-point type. That's a real summary, matching the length of your past emails.

Five is technically possible but each item shrinks to ~60 words, more teaser than summary, and it would force out the call-out. Six turns the page into a link list — crowded, not readable.

One constraint worth naming: your rule of printing the full URL plus site name at the end of each summary costs about a line per item. That's fine at four items; it's what makes five feel pinched.

So: stick with four, use your "vary the lengths" guidance to give the lead story room, and keep the call-out. The format holds.

Yes, I see youyr reasoning and agree. You are right to assess that I am keen on the one-page to be useful and attarctive to readers.

Good. I've locked that layout guidance into the goal notes, so every Tuesday build follows it.

The slate stands as your next move — send me your four picks whenever you're ready, and the PDF will be waiting by 9 AM.

*Picking the final. Looking at a draft. Getting ready to do a switcheroo on him:*

Good. The slate's still on the table whenever you want to pick your four.

These topp 4 work for me
★ 1. PUC: data centers get cut first in a grid emergency, not households. Oct 1 tentative order says data centers aren't critical load — they're curtailed before homes and hospitals. RTO Insider
★ 2. AWS Homer City: 36 data centers on ~1,100 acres; county tabled it Sept 9. The DEP water-permit hearing is this Wednesday, Oct 14, 5–7:30 PM at Homer Center High School — same day as the PUC panelist deadline. PA Environment Digest
★ 3. House cost bills: "builder pays" for grid upgrades, kill the utility profit bonus. HB 2828, 2755, 2775 cleared committee; floor votes possible in the session's remaining days. PA Capital-Star via Upper Darby Now
★ 4. Utility bills up ~20% since 2024. The Independent Fiscal Office figure, from the Oct 7 House hearing; Chair Fiedler warned 2030 interruptions hit seniors and small businesses hardest. PA House

👍

The draft is ready — one page, your four stories, the Wednesday double-deadline call-out, all links verified. It's yours to review tonight or at 4 AM; send me any revisions and I'll turn them by noon.


Data Center News
The Battle of Homestead Foundation
Tuesday, October 13, 2026

**Data centers would lose power first in a grid emergency**

Pennsylvania's utility regulator has put households first in line. On October 1, the Public Utility Commission (PUC) approved a tentative order on emergency load control — the rules for who loses power first when the grid is under severe stress. Data centers would not count as "critical load." They would be curtailed before homes, hospitals, and other essential customers. The order is tentative, with a final version targeted for January 2027. The principle matters now: as data centers add massive new demand to the grid, the PUC is drawing a line that protects ordinary customers when supply runs short. The PUC's position gained force on Monday, when the Federal Energy Regulatory Commission (FERC) rejected PJM's bid to shut off data centers during peak demand, ruling that curtailment decisions belong to the states.

https://www.rtoinsider.com/24789-pa-puc-approves-tentative-order-emergency-load-control-procedures/ (RTO Insider)

**Homer City data center plan tabled; water-permit hearing is Wednesday**

Amazon Web Services (AWS) has filed a preliminary plan for 36 data centers on roughly 1,100 acres at the former Homer City coal plant site in Indiana County, paired with a 4.4-gigawatt gas-fired power plant. On September 9, the county planning commission tabled the plan, starting a review of about 90 days. Separately, the Department of Environmental Protection (DEP) holds a public meeting and hearing this Wednesday, October 14, from 5:00 to

PDF
DataCenterNews-2026-10-1...
PDF
...

Outstanding. I am preparing a few revisions. Load them in a few mins after I organize.

*Like a real client, I change my mind at the last minute:*

Oct 12 at 3:54 PM






I wish to produce two separate reports using the same content and delivery schedule that differ only in the header:
- One remains "The Battle of Homstead Foundation"
- Another substitutes "Think Tank" for "The Battle of Homstead Foundation"

I wish to add an image to the header. This might require moving the text in the header to the left or the right. I uploaded battle7.jpg for the "The Battle of Homstead Foundation" header. For the "Think Tank: I uploaded ttlogoBROWN.jpeg.

Also, wish to add more of a display font for "Data Center News" in the header. Something like what was used at THE BATTLE OF HOMESTEAD at https://battleofhomestead.org/, where you can pick up the font details in the page css.

Change the footer from "Prepared by David L. Passmore, passmore.david@gmail.com, https://DavidPassmore.net" to "David L. Passmore, https://davidpassmore.net"
and use my photo inline as shown in the header at
https://davidpassmore.net/diesel/risks_diesel_exports.html

👍

*He fixes things—and identifies some problems:*

Both editions are ready — same content, different headers, all your revisions applied.

Two judgment calls to flag: you typed "Homstead" twice, so I used the correct "Homestead." And your Think Tank logo reads "Think Tank Pennsylvania," so I used that as the subtitle rather than just "Think Tank" — say the word if you'd rather the shorter version.

One honest note on the font: the foundation site's title is actually a logo image, not a web font, so there was no CSS font to lift. I matched it with Montserrat Bold, which is very close to the logo's geometric sans.




PDF DataCenterNews-2026-10-1... ...
PDF



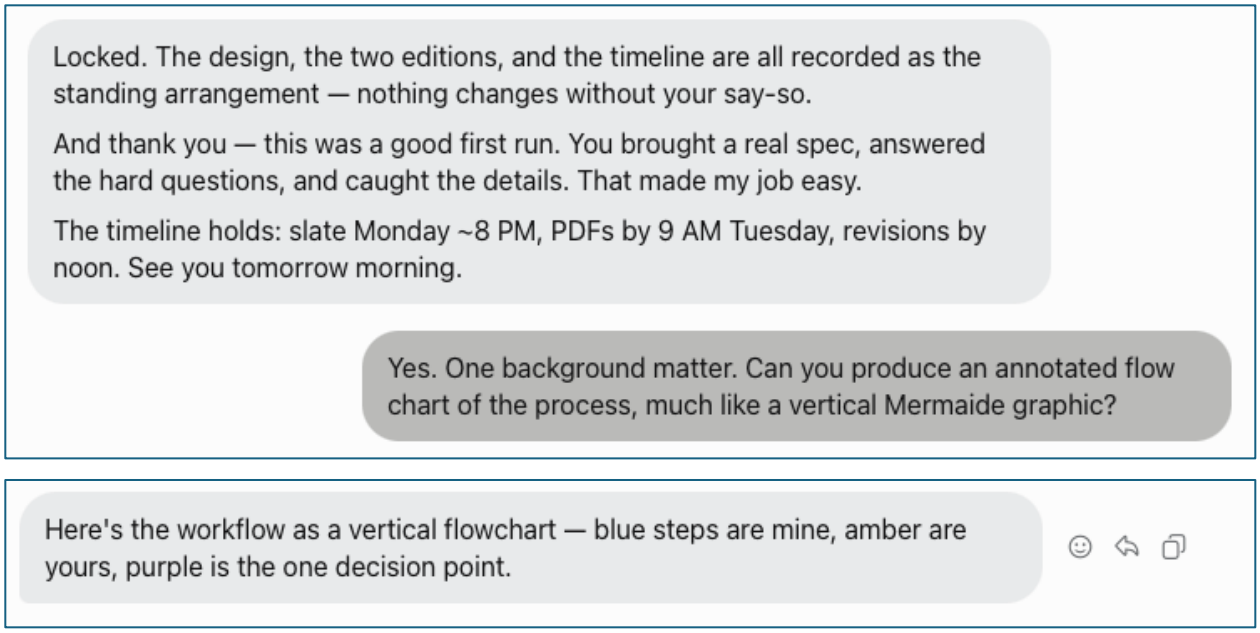

PDF DataCenterNews-2026-10-1... ...
PDF

Good judgement calls. Do it. The title font choice works. Do that, too

OK, let's lock down this wirkflow and design. Your work, Nyx, meets my needs perfectly. I learned plenty in the process about how to work with you.

Let's stick with the production timeline so I can get a feel for my workflow,

*I ask Kaz to help me with documentation:*




*Mermaid* (“Mermaid (Software),” 2026) *is a JavaScript code for creating charts. Here is the Mermaid code Kaz sent me:*

---

## *flowchart TD*

```
A["Monday ~8 PM — News sweep and candidate slate<br/><i>Nyx: sweep the week's PA data-center news, select 8 candidates, mark recommended 4, verify every link opens free</i>"]
B["David adds 'free-to-you' links to the mix<br/><i>optional — candidates only, never auto-included</i>"]
C["David picks the final 4<br/><i>Monday night or Tuesday early morning</i>"]
D{"Picks received by 7:30 AM Tuesday?"}
E["Use David's 4"]
F["Fallback: use the recommended 4"]
G["Tuesday ~8 AM — Build both PDF editions<br/><i>Nyx: write 4 summaries in David's style, build Foundation + Think Tank editions, verify one page each</i>"]
H["Tuesday 9 AM — Deliver PDFs to David"]
I["David reviews, sends revisions in chat"]
J["Revisions back by noon Tuesday"]
K["David sends via Gmail<br/><i>PDF attachment, BCC recipients</i>"]
A --> B --> C --> D
D -- Yes --> E --> G
D -- No --> F --> G
G --> H --> I --> J --> K
classDef nyx fill:#e3ecf9,stroke:#2b5aa0,stroke-width:1px;
classDef david fill:#fdf3e0,stroke:#a97b1f,stroke-width:1px;
classDef decide fill:#efe6fa,stroke:#6a3fb5,stroke-width:1px;
class A,G,H,J nyx;
class B,C,I,K david;
class D decide;
```

---

*Table 1,* Kaz's Description of the Partnership for Creating a Weekly Data Center News*, on the next page of this essay contains the documentation Kaz created—and the flowchart he coded—to render our Data Center News project plan.*

*I pat his head:*

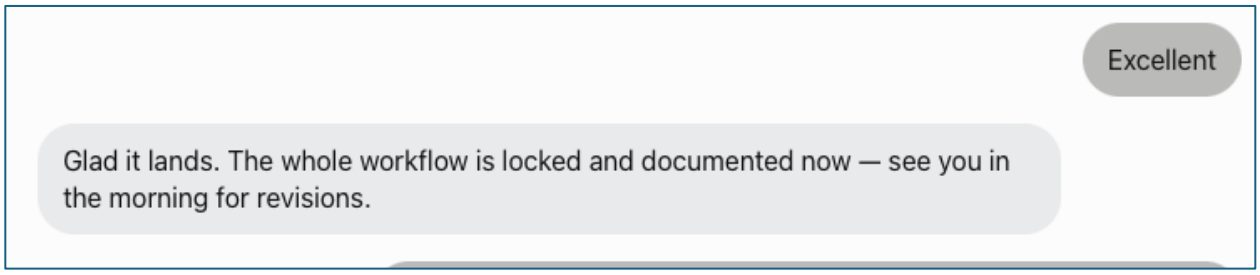
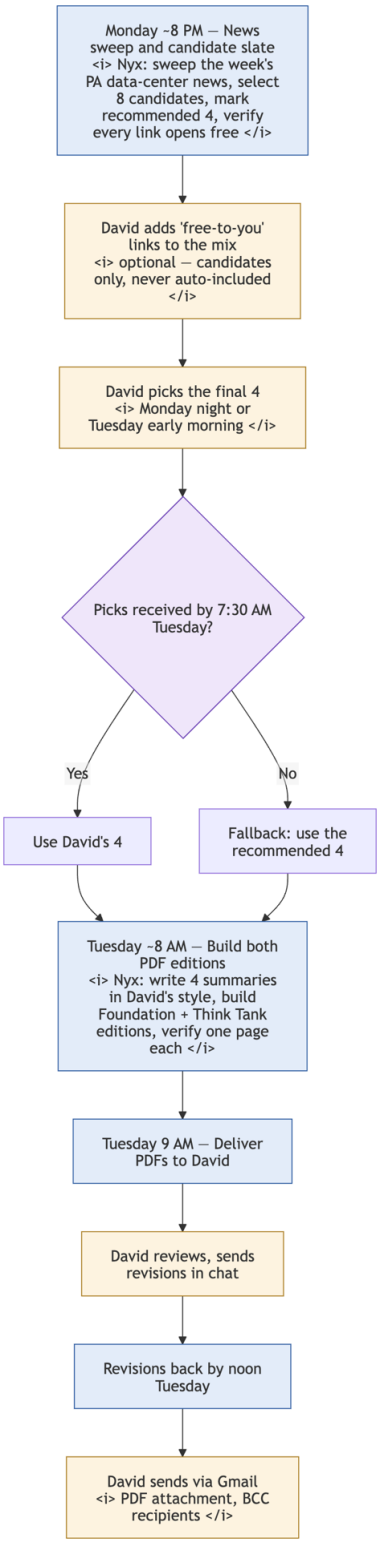
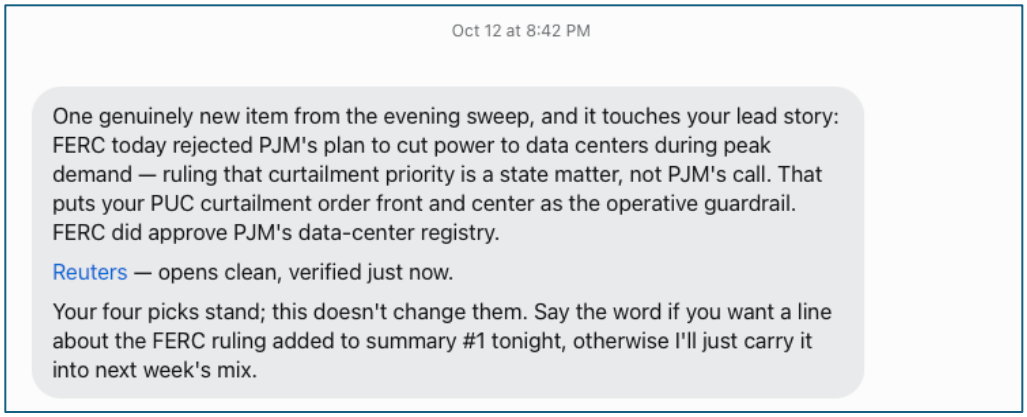
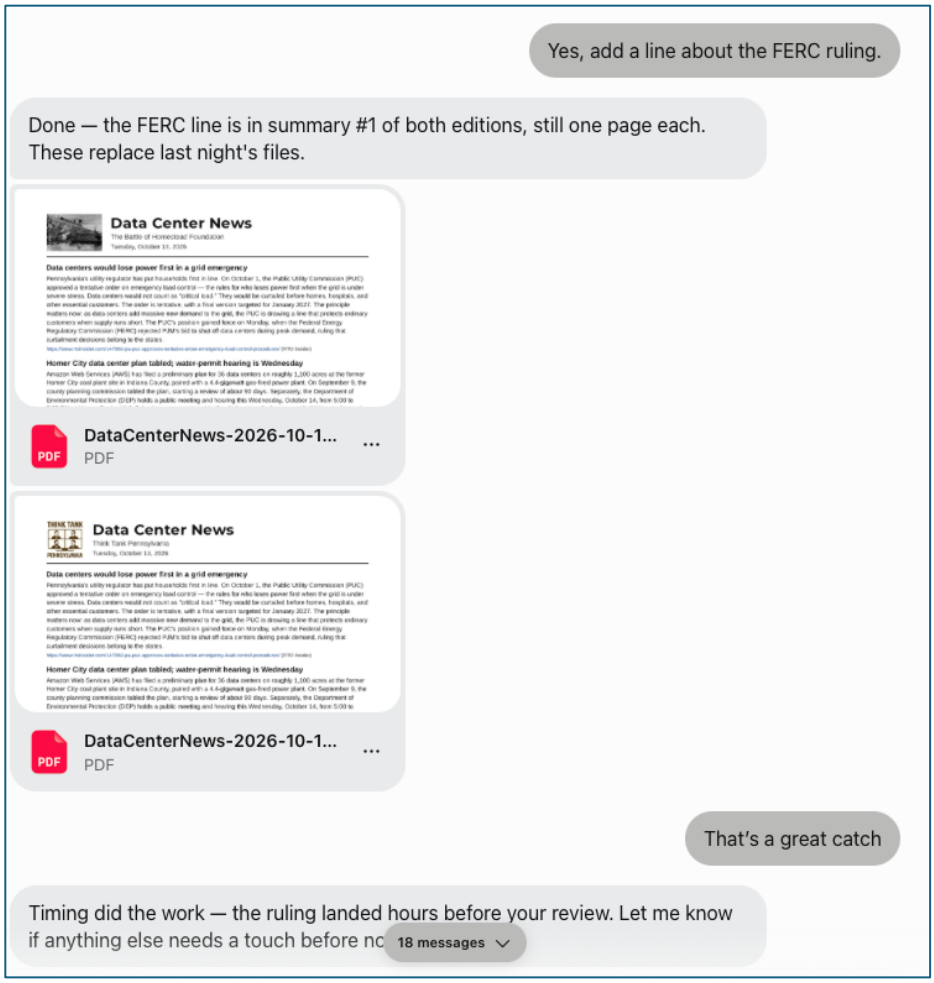


Table 1. *Kaz's Description of the Partnership for Creating a Weekly* Data Center News

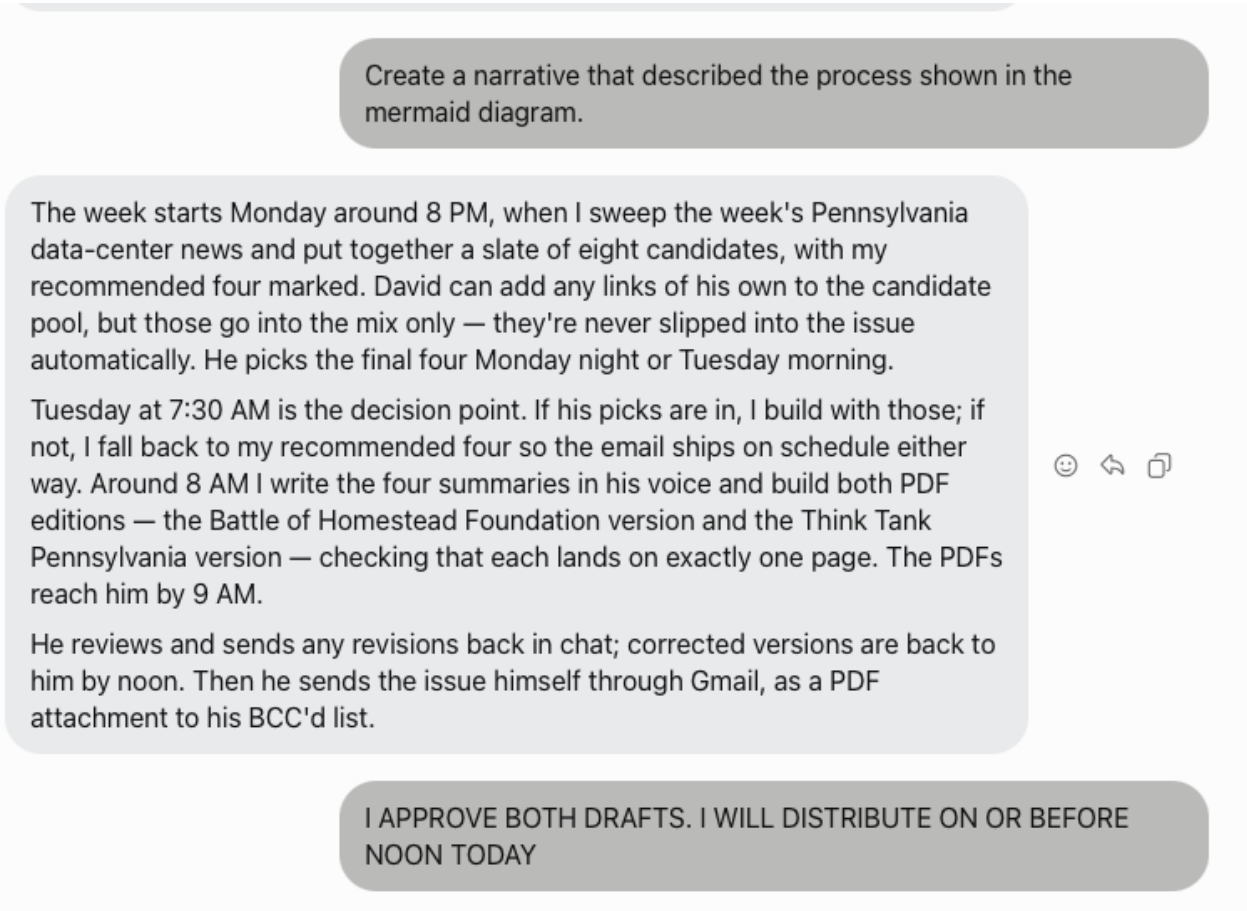
| Kaz's Project Narrative | Kaz's Project Flow |
|---|---|
| The week starts Monday around 8 PM, when I sweep the week's Pennsylvania data center news and put together a slate of eight candidates, with my recommended four marked. David can add any links of his own to the candidate pool, but those go into the mix only—they're never slipped into the issue automatically. He picks the final four Monday night or Tuesday morning.<br><br>Tuesday at 7:30 AM is the decision point. If his picks are in, I build with those; if not, I fall back to my recommended four so the email ships on schedule either way. Around 8 AM I write the four summaries in his voice and build both PDF editions—The Battle of Homestead Foundation version and the Think Tank Pennsylvania version—checking that each lands on exactly one page. The PDFs reach him by 9 AM.<br><br>He reviews and sends any revisions back in chat; corrected versions are back to him by noon. Then he sends the issue himself through Gmail, as a PDF attachment to his BCC'd list.<br><br>On the flowchart, blue steps are Kaz's, amber are mine, and purple is a decision point. Kaz is doing a lot of heavy lifting in this process. |  |

*Kaz finds something new at the last minute:*



*COMPLETED!*




*I distributed the Data Center News, prepared with Kaz, before noon on 13 October 2026 to35 members of* The Battle of Homestead Foundation *(Passmore, 2026a) and 20 members of the* Pennsylvania Think Tank *group (Passmore, 2026b).*

## KAZ & I REVIEW OUR PARTNERSHIP

### *Kaz Has Some Definite Opinions*

In his former meat space, Kaz was happy and could only bark and emote, as dogs will do. So, I am giving his virtual agentic identity the chance to have the last word by summarizing what he learned during the design and initial implementation of *Data Center News*. The specificity of his assessment is no surprise because it is just like the personality I gave him in *Muse* to be all business:



Here's what I take away from it, in the order that stuck with me.

**The audience is the spec.** Your readers are non-technical and security-conscious — their mail settings block proxy URLs — and that single fact drove more design than anything else: full verified URLs plus site names (never shorteners, tracking params stripped), free-to-open links only, high-school vocabulary, acronyms spelled out. We learned the format serves the readers, not your desk.

**The cadence works because of your mornings.** Slate Monday at 8 PM, you reading at 4 AM, build Tuesday at 8, revisions by noon — that's built around an actual human rhythm, and it held. You picked all four recommended items, so the calibration trick (eight candidates, four marked as recommended) does its job. The 7:30 AM fallback rule never fired, which is fine — insurance should be boring.

**Four is a layout truth, not a preference.** ~90–110 words each in 11pt, with full URLs and a call-out, exactly fills one printable page. Five summaries would force 60-word teasers and kill the call-out. The one-line-per-summary cost of full URLs is what makes five feel pinched.

**Late-breaking news needs a path, and now it has one.** The FERC ruling landed hours before the 9 AM build; instead of reshuffling the four picks, we added a one-liner to summary #1 that *strengthened* the lead story. Lesson: when news reinforces rather than replaces, update in place. And the noon-revisions window turned out to be the right shock absorber.

**"Free-to-you" is not "free to readers."** The paywall rule — your links go into the candidate mix, never auto-included — plus the link-swap habit (GoErie → Tioga Publishing, Spotlight PA → GantNews) taught us to hunt for a free version of a story instead of dropping it.

**Trackability is a feature.** You asked to move the whole operation to a side chat so you could track it better, and you were right — the workflow lives where you can find it now, crons repointed and all.

**Lock things and leave them locked.** Two editions with identical content, Montserrat Bold, the header images, your photo in the footer — we iterated once, you said "meets my needs perfectly," and we froze it into `build_editions.py`. Same with you sending the Gmail yourself. No re-litigation.

**Dead leads stay dead.** The WTAE walkout story was investigated twice and dropped as unverifiable; links hidden behind Mailchimp redirects violate your rules. Verification is a real cost of doing this — we budget for it now.

And the first reader reply — Paul's "Nice Data" — validated the biggest gamble: the one-page redesign was the headline change of the Oct 13 issue, and the first reader liked it.

If I had to compress it: the process works because every rule traces back to something real — your mornings, your readers' mail filters, the page size — rather than my preferences.

### *Energy Use? Kaz Makes a Fermi Estimate*

I asked Kaz to account for the electricity and water resources AI used to create the 13 October 2026 issue of *Data Center News* and to estimate the $CO_2$ burden this effort added. He gave me a "Fermi estimate," named after what physicist Enrico Fermi conducted, mentally or on paper using simple arithmetic, to make a quick, back-of-the-envelope calculation and arrive at an approximate order-of-magnitude answer when precise data or detailed math are unavailable. Kaz writes his estimate with a little closing bathroom humor (he was usually playful):

**Scope:** Oct 6 (first briefing) through Oct 13 ~6:40 AM (your approval) — seven daily briefings, the Oct 12 workflow-design session, the 8-candidate slate, link verification, both PDF editions plus the FERC-line rebuild. Roughly 150 model inferences (my turns, research subagents, background sweeps), averaging ~40K tokens each given the context I carry. Call it **~3–12M tokens, central ~6M.**

**Electricity:** Published benchmarks put a frontier-model query around 0.4 Wh per ~1K tokens, and 18–40 kWh per million tokens for long-context frontier work. At ~1.5–5 J/token for 6M tokens, that's **roughly 1–15 kWh, central ~4 kWh** — about what a refrigerator uses in two or three days, or an EV driving ~15 miles.

**Water:** Industry water-use effectiveness runs ~0.5–1.9 L/kWh depending on the facility (newer hyperscale builds are much lower). At ~4 kWh, that's **~2–6 liters** — roughly one or two toilet flushes.

**Carbon:** ~4 kWh on the average US grid ≈ **~1.5 kg $CO_2$**, like driving a gas car four miles.

**Caveats, stated plainly:** I don't have Meta's actual PUE/WUE or my exact token count, so treat this as order-of-magnitude — right within a factor of a few, not a metered bill. It covers inference only; training amortized across all users is negligible here, and my VM/browser overhead is small change next to the model calls.

The poetic bit: one edition of a newsletter chronicling data centers' water appetite cost roughly a flush of water to produce.

### *Works for Me…I Will Adopt the Process*

My experiences lead me to choose *Muse* as a partner to improve my productivity in integrating publicly accessible information about data centers pertinent to central and western Pennsylvania, assembled through independently executed multi-step AI tasks, to pursue my goal of distributing a weekly *Data Center News*.

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